

CENTRE STAGE
Fountain of Joy at the Jio World Centre in Mumbai

A KEY OBJECTIVE OF WAVES IS TO HAVE GLOBAL M&E LEADERS INVEST IN INDIA AS WELL AS ENCOURAGE DISCUSSIONS, GENERATE IDEAS, FACILITATE INNOVATION AND COLLABORATIONS

They include a masterclass by Bollywood star Aamir Khan; filmmaker Karan Johar in conversation with Bollywood star Shah Rukh Khan; tributes to yesteryear actors Manoj Kumar and Smita Patil; and performances by Oscar-winning music composers A.R. Rahman and M.M. Keeravani, as well as singers Shreya Ghoshal and Shankar Mahadevan. The event will also champion the generation next of Indian creators in 32 categories, including animation, gaming, broadcasting, comics, radio, advertising and film, through an award ceremony on day two.

One of the key objectives of the summit is to have global M&E leaders invest in India through the platform as well as encourage discussions, generate ideas, facilitate innovation and collaborations with heavyweights in the sector from across the world. This week, at a roadshow in Hyderabad to promote the summit, Sanjay Jaju, secretary, I&B ministry, said WAVES would be the first-ever global summit covering the entire gamut of the M&E industry.

The international outreach of the summit is evident by a line-up that boasts Adobe CEO Shantanu Narayen, YouTube CEO Neal Mohan, Instagram head Adam Mosseri, Netflix CEO Ted Sarandos, marketing agency WPP's CEO Mark Read, Spotify's chief public affairs officer Dustee Jenkins, and NVIDIA's vice president Richard Kerris—all of them will be part of the programming roster.

The purview of WAVES is not limited to films; it considers the fast-growing M&E scene. Apart from traditional media like print, TV and radio, there will also be participation from stakeholders in streaming platforms, AI (artificial intelligence), AR and VR (augmented and virtual reality), e-sport athletes, content creators and influencers. In fact, India Today Group's own AI news anchor Sana will be moderating a session titled 'The Hyper-Personalised Ad Revolution: Connecting One-to-One'. Other highlights of the event include Waves Bazaar, an industry-led global marketplace that seeks to identify business partners for tie-ups and bring together buyers and sellers from different countries, and Bharat Pavilion, a space that celebrates #KalaToCode by charting the country's journey from its ancient heritage to a future-ready avatar.

The ministry hopes that the summit will promote India as a "one-stop destination" for content creation, drive the country's creative economy through intellectual property creation and develop its M&E infrastructure, as also build the industry's capacity to create a skilled workforce for global needs. ■

ON THE AGENDA

- **Amitabh Bachchan, Rajinikanth, Chiranjeevi, Mohanlal, Hema Malini and Mithun Chakraborty in a session moderated by Akshay Kumar**
- **A masterclass on 'redefining Indian cinema' by Aamir Khan**
- **Karan Johar in conversation with Shah Rukh Khan**
- **Performances by A.R. Rahman and M.M. Keeravani, and Shreya Ghoshal and Shankar Mahadevan**
- **The generation next of Indian creators in 32 categories will be awarded**
- **India Today Group's AI news anchor Sana to moderate a session**